

have the opportunity to learn from our peers, practice, and get feedback in an interactive way. It's also a great way to make new hires feel welcome and a part of our sales culture at GitLab. All sellers in Enterprise Sales participate in the shadow program in some way - whether they shadow or host their peers.

The Enterprise Seller playbook

The Enterprise Seller playbook is how a typical, high-performing SAE runs their business on an annual, quarterly, monthly, and weekly basis. Use it as a guide to understand the basics of what key activities and collaboration points are required for things to run smoothly in your territory. This includes collaborating with your deal team. This playbook aligns directly to the manager version used by Area Sales Managers in Enterprise Sales.

Collaborating with your team

As the account lead, your role centers on successfully orchestrating all of the resources and support available to you and your prospect or customer to reach their defined outcome on a reasonable timeline. That means knowing who's who and how to collaborate with them.

View the Enterprise Seller playbook for guidance on what types of meetings to host with your deal team and extended team, as well as how their roles and responsibilities might intersect with yours.

At a glance: How to collaborate with extended deal team members

|Extended deal team members | How you collaborate |

|-----|-----|

|Channel Account Manager (CAM):| Understand and map the partner landscape: opportunities and collaborations, suggest partners for onboarding and recruiting, incorporate System Integrators into your plan, view current partners in the Partner Directory |

|Professional services:| Match the needs of your solution or customer to training, education, and adoption or deployment support provided by this team. Or bring them in to help you pitch services to your prospects or customers.|

|Field marketing and account-based marketing:| Include this team during strategic planning for your territory, accounts, and pipe generation. And when planning to run & host events or webinars, attend relevant third-party events. Learn what's scheduled: GitLab event site , All marketing activities (internal). Nominate priority accounts for Account-based marketing (ABM) support. Slack: abmteam, emeamarketing (EMEA), fieldmarketing (Global)|

| Sales leaders and executives | You may need to provide executive sponsorship of an account, request an e-group member in a meeting, or request that the CEO join a meeting |

|Sales operations and deal desk: |For structuring and closing deals, you'll often work with Deal Desk, especially for non-standard quotes. sales-support is also the go-to channel for any urgent questions around progressing a deal through our processes. |

| GitLab Support: | The Support Team serves our customers at different levels depending on what they've purchased.|

|Product team: | For strategic deals, it often makes sense to bring in an expert from Product to speak to your customer about the benefits or maturity of features they care about the most. Often times, if something is not yet possible in GitLab, Product has a plan and roadmap for when it will be available. |

|Strategic Field Organization| Or the strategic field team for large engagements that require a

high degree of strategic planning - such as DevSecOps transformation, solution recommendations, and advisory for our customer's senior technical leadership in high-value, strategic deals (\$400k+). |

| Compete:| You may also bring in the compete team to help with intelligence or positioning. Use the competition channel on Slack to collaborate and view important resources in their bookmarks. |

| Customer Advocacy team:| You may want to construct a deal where the customer agrees to be reference or to logo usage, or perhaps you've delivered incredible value and they are ready to be a case study. |

Sales planning

Every Strategic Account Executive in Enterprise Sales should have a territory plan for how they're approaching their patch.

- The first step is to create a sales territory plan: a collaborative, workable plan for targeting the right customers and implementing goals for income and consistent sales growth over time. It's usually done annually and updated throughout the year.
- Your MVP territory plan will help you prioritize and rank your accounts. We use the Account Rank field in Salesforce to mark priority accounts.
- This is followed by creating account plans for those accounts. Every priority account identified in your territory plan should have an account plan complete and linked in the Gainsight overview in Salesforce.
- View the territory planning template and worksheet in our internal handbook. And view the account planning template [here](#).
- And view additional data sources and reports in the plan template (beneath the slides) as well as at the bottom of this page.
- If an account is moving to a new seller, use the Account Handover issue template and associated process to give the new rep everything they need to best support their customer.

Prospecting and keeping your pipeline healthy

View important guidance on the Sales Prospecting handbook page. The expectation for Enterprise Sellers is that they have 3.5x pipe coverage.

Generally, surprises - whether in the form of sudden, major deals or sudden, major losses - are a bad thing. We have to strive to create predictable results. At first, this seems like trying to predict the vast unknown. But if you have a strong strategy in place for your pipeline, you'll be able to see exactly how your year will turn out well before it happens. This means better, more reliable forecasts and less stress for you on whether you'll meet that target. When forecasting, use the Sales Forecasting handbook page and Clari cheat sheet to help you.

Validate, validate, validate. Effective qualification is just the first step. As you invest in a prospect, it's important to continuously validate the opportunity throughout the sales cycle and make sure it can deliver results for you and that we are the effective solution for the prospect.

Moving a deal through the pipeline

Pipeline management is key to predictable, scalable revenue attainment and can make the

difference between simply hitting your number and overachieving. It helps you allocate your time correctly, increase deal velocity, and increase total deal volume, size, and revenue through accurate forecasting practices.

The Sales Stages Criteria defines activities and exit criteria for each stage and serves as a roadmap for moving a deal from discovery to closed won (or qualified out quickly).

- View GitLab's Sales Stages, criteria, and resources on this Highspot page

How to use it: As you move a deal through the pipeline, the Sales Stage criteria defines activities and exit criteria for each stage and serves as a roadmap to getting a deal from discovery to closed won (or qualified out quickly). Use it to help you validate your opportunity and forecast it correctly. This guidance gives definitions for each stage, tells you who might be involved on your team, what activities are typically done in each stage, and what is required before you can move it further in the pipeline.

Additional resources for opportunity management:

During each stage in the detailed spreadsheet, you'll also see major strategic resources that can help you be successful during each milestone of a deal - from prospecting to transitioning to a the post-sales team. For operational resources, head to the general sales page up top. For commonly used sales assets like marketing plays and pitch decks, head to the marketing resources handbook page.

Opportunity management

Opp management starts with effective discovery. At GitLab, that means MEDDPICC and having a complete Command Plan for all \$50k+ NARR opportunities.

Use data to validate your opportunities. If you're making big bets because you 'hope' a prospect will change their mind it's a sign that you need to go back to the validation process:

- What evidence do you have that this deal is 'real'?
- What data tells you it will happen this quarter or next?
- What is not being talked about is usually a sign something is not going as planned. For example, do you know their paper process inside and out? Do you know the potential people on their team that could derail the deal later?
- Meet with your team and get their help and feedback on validating what's in your pipeline and hold regular meeting cadences with them to walk through your top prospects.

Keep your opps squeaky clean: Pay attention to how long something has been sitting in a specific stage, and close it out when the time is right. For a tech company, the average strategic deal takes 6 months to a year to close. While it's normal for an opportunity to sit, holding it prevents another team (or other resources) from helping it progress.

Holding hurts our prospective customers because while they're sitting there, they aren't getting any real value from us (and likely to get more value from a competitor). It's for their benefit that we push deals along or move them to close.

Sales enablement resources

If you're looking for templates, guides, customer 1-pagers, and other editable sales content, head to the Enterprise Sales Highspot page. If you're looking for skills-based training, LevelUp is where you need to go.

External training opportunities: GitLab also has a robust growth and development benefit to help you supplement your learning. And if you want to stretch your technical muscle and hear customer feedback, you can sign up to join our audiences in our CS webinars.

If you want to know more about what's available to help you be successful, reach out to your enablement lead in the field-enablement Slack channel.

Quick links to common tools

If you don't have access to the items below and believe you should, open an Access Request.

Executing your strategy

- GitLab Version Compare Tool, also known as the 'What's new since?' tool, is a tool that allows you to populate a comparison all the additional features and functions from one version of GitLab to another (or the current release). Use it with your customers to understand what product they purchased previously, and what the value is now to support your proposals and pricing. Using this tool a quarter before the renewal or whenever you start contract discussions can be helpful in showing all the work we continue to build into the product.
- Gainsight is used for documenting account details, timelines, and objectives
- Zendesk is our ticketing system. Access is usually provided during onboarding. Ask your manager if you need access to Zendesk.
- LucidChart for creating diagrams and org charts for account plans.
- Chorus is used to view recordings of GitLab sales calls and demos.
- Use GitLab's Design Toolkit to download our logos, access our illustration and icon libraries, and build out your documents and presentations for prospects and customers.
- Product Usage Data & Health Scores in Gainsight is used by your CSM and can provide you with insights into current customer usage data by use case by walking you through the relevant dashboard in Gainsight. All AEs have read access to Gainsight. Health scores can be found in Salesforce at the account level as well. When running a report on your accounts, pull in the Health Score field to understand what urgent actions you may need to take.
- CustomersDot Admin (see overview video here): most customers have an account that breaks down their purchases and provides some insight into SaaS usage. Also good for linking purchases to VersionDot usage data

Prospecting tools

- Completing RFPs/RFxs (Requests for vendor information): Use the RFP process here combined with our Trust Center page
- Learn what events we're attending or sponsoring via the GitLab event site (external) and the marketing activities spreadsheet (internal). Or work with your local field marketer or manager to plan your own smaller-scale event.
- LinkedIn Sales Navigator is one of the main prospecting tools we use at GitLab. It features a powerful set of search capabilities, improved visibility into extended networks, and personalized algorithms to help you reach the right decision maker. All SAEs have access to LSN. And view additional videos and tutorials on the handbook page.

- Salesforce Inbox is a productivity tool to integrate Salesforce with emails. You may need to request access. View the [Salesforce Inbox](#)
- Outreach.io is a tool used to automate emails in the form of sequences. Users can track open rates, click through rates, response rates for various templates and update sequences based on these metrics. Outreach.io also helps to track sales activities such as calls. All emails/calls/tasks that are made through Outreach.io are automatically logged in Salesforce with a corresponding disposition.
- Conversica is a conversational AI tool that helps enterprise marketing, sales, customer success, and finance teams attract, acquire and grow customers at scale across the customer revenue lifecycle. The AI Assistant works by engaging the prospect in a human-like conversation over email in an effort to further qualify the prospect.
- Thnks is a way to send small tokens of appreciation to customers, prospects, or contacts while only needing an email or phone. It's not provided by GitLab at this time, but you can talk to your manager about options for expensing. Remember to abide by our policies around gifts for prospects or customers and check with legal in Slack if you have questions.
- The GitLab Swag store is another way to send thanks or share the GitLab spirit with business contacts or family. View our policies on swag [here](#). Remember to abide by our policies around gifts for prospects or customers and check with legal in Slack if you have questions. You can also use the swag channel in Slack to get urgent questions answered.

Understanding your business

- View internal data resources in our internal handbook for Territory Planning [here](#).
- Salesforce (View in Okta), including reports that contain propensity model data.
- Clari is used to view and document forecasting and pipeline data.
- Tableau is a data visualization tool. Your manager can send you specific dashboards relevant to your team to view.
- Datafox is used to view relevant account information.
- GitLab Propensity Models allow you to dive deep into data provided by our Data Science Team including Propensity to Buy, Propensity to Churn, and Propensity to Expand. You can also find these fields in Salesforce and use them to inform your strategy in your territory.

Looking for information on the Commercial Sales Organization? View the Commercial Sales Playbook [here](#).

SECTION: sales/playbook/discovery/index.md

Overview

Effective discovery is critical to thoroughly understanding customer needs and establishes the foundation for being able to effectively articulate GitLab's value and differentiation in a compelling, customer-centric way. Effective discovery will help you attach to your customers' biggest problems, gain access to higher-level business stakeholders, and serve as a trusted advisor to your customers. This, in turn, will help you build and maintain a healthy and predictable pipeline, to meet and exceed your sales goals while helping your customers achieve their business objectives. After reviewing the below information, GitLab field team members are encouraged to take the interactive Effective Discovery course in GitLab Learn.

Qualification

The first phase of any discovery process is to determine whether or not you should spend time on a particular opportunity pursuit. A good guide for this phase is codified in the Criteria for Sales Accepted Opportunity (SAO) and includes confirmation of Authority, Initiative, Fit, and Timing.

Ideally, effective qualification also includes identification of the prospect's:

- Cloud strategy
- Preferred cloud partner(s)
- Future growth potential (Landed Addressable Market (LAM)), and
- Preference for SaaS or Self-Managed

Understand Value Points

The second phase of discovery uses an iterative insight/question loop, often across multiple meetings or conversations, to uncover the prospect's underlying challenges and motivations, with the ultimate goal of constructing a highly relevant and differentiated value message that ties the GitLab solution to the prospect's business needs.

Preparation

Ensure you are ready for each discussion. The level of preparation for each discovery conversation will vary, so use your best judgment for how deep you go and be sure to leverage the information that has already been collected during Prospecting and Qualification. The key point is to be prepared and to not just wing it. Consider the below recommendations.

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Research the Prospect

Researching your prospect may include but is not limited to:

- Annual reports and/or financial statements
- Account activity/engagement history in Salesforce
- Recent news or press releases
- Research your contact(s) on LinkedIn, Twitter, and/or other social media platforms
- Insights gleaned from partners that already have relationships with the account

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Understand the Persona

Different roles within the prospect's organization will inherently care about and be motivated by different things. Leverage the below resources to understand the challenges and motivations of the persona you are engaging.

- Buyer personas
- User personas

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Develop a Pre-Call Plan

As outlined in the Pre-Call Plan job aid, be sure to consider the below questions.

- What is your desired outcome for this conversation or meeting? What do you think the prospect's desired outcome is?
- What information do you need to gather to achieve your objective(s)? What discovery questions will you ask, how, and in what sequence? As outlined above, this iterative insight/question loop will often span across multiple meetings or conversations.
 - Start with Customer Strategy-based discovery questions to seek to understand your prospect's goals, objectives, and initiatives
 - Next, ask open-ended Customer Needs-based discovery questions in pursuit of understanding your prospect's desired outcomes, current situation and environment and level of satisfaction, and motivations (including personal needs)
- As you develop and prioritize your discovery questions, what types of questions will you ask that reinforce GitLab's differentiators?
 - For a deeper dive, re-review the Defensible Differentiators content and sample questions in the GitLab Value Framework doc (see top asset highlighted in the Resources: Core Content (internal only) section of the Command of the Message Internal Handbook page)
- What agenda will provide the structure needed to help you achieve your meeting or call objectives? Assuming you achieve your objective(s), what are possible next steps you may recommend? How will you close the call or meeting to progress the opportunity further?
- What are some potentially relevant success stories (e.g. same industry, geo, anticipated pain points, etc.) and other proof points (e.g. favorable analyst report) that you may want to reference or highlight to build interest and credibility?
- What questions or objections do you anticipate the prospect may have? If those indeed come up, are you ready to respond?

Seek to Understand

Approach With Curiosity

Approach discovery conversations with a curiosity-led mindset and a desire to better understand the customer's challenges as well as the implications of those challenges.

- How big is the problem?
- How does this impact higher-level goals and objectives?
- How does this challenge impact the person(s) with whom you are talking?
- Who else in the organization does this challenge impact and how?

TED

Leverage the TED questioning model (see below) to get the prospect to open up and provide more context and detail about their challenges.

- T: Tell me more about...
- E: Can you please explain the impact of...?
- D: Will you please describe how others are affected by...?

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Five Whys

Use the Five Whys technique to identify the root cause(s) and understand the "So what?" Check out the short video below and read the Why Salespeople Should Ask The Same Question 5 Times In A Row blog to learn more.

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Active Listening

Commit to active and effective listening. Watch the video, listen to the podcasts, and check out the Why Your Active Listening Skills Are Crucial to Hitting Your Number blog.

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Master Command of the Message

Command of the Message is a proven, value-based sales messaging methodology from Force Management that allows GitLab sales team members to effectively uncover customer needs and articulate value and differentiation. Leverage the below resources to ensure you are confident in the methodology and the GitLab-tailored sales resources created to help you be successful and delight your customers.

- Command of the Message Handbook page
- Command of the Message e-learning module (90 minutes) (GitLab internal with protected IP from Force Management)

Identify the Buying Process

The final phase of discovery identifies the roadmap, along with potential roadblocks, for getting a deal closed as well as key stakeholders who must be involved. Discovery will continue throughout the sales process as you and your account team continue to gain a deeper understanding of all elements of MEDDPICC to increase the likelihood of earning the customer's business.

- Leverage Customer Decision-based discovery questions to gain a better understanding of the Decision Process, Decision Criteria, Paper Process, and more
- Check out the full MEDDPICC Handbook page
- Complete the MEDDPICC e-learning module (60 minutes, GitLab internal)

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Avoid These Discovery Pitfalls

Lack of Preparation

See the above section for tips to avoid what may be the most common discovery pitfall.

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Happy Ears

Resist the urge to prematurely talk about or begin to position GitLab until you have a thorough understanding of the customer's challenges, the implications of those challenges, how big the problem is, the urgency of the problem, who cares about the problem and why, and more (see

below).

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Not Attaching to the Biggest Problem

You must have a solid understanding of the prospect's key business drivers, strategic business initiatives, and associated objectives and goals to be able to serve as a trusted advisor. These will almost assuredly relate to one or more Customer Value Drivers. Use Customer Strategy-based discovery questions followed by Customer Needs-based discovery questions to identify how GitLab can have a positive impact on your buyer's business issues.

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Failing to Identify the Negative Consequences of Doing Nothing

Watch the short videos below to learn more about the importance of seeking to understand, and helping your prospect understand, the negative implications of their current state. As a salesperson, you must understand the difference between the prospect's current state and the future state that GitLab can help deliver and effectively articulate that difference in a way that compels them to take action.

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Lack of Multi-Threading

Sales multi-threading refers to the concept of engaging and developing relationships with multiple stakeholders who are involved in your customer's decision-making process. According to CEB Global, the average B2B deal has 5.8 decision-makers, and that number typically increases along with the size and complexity of the contract. Even if your primary contact has significant authority in the organization, that may be insufficient if the rest of the buying group is not on board with the decision. Therefore, the more connections you have from the buying side, the better your chances of getting a deal closed. To learn more, check out the below articles/blogs and podcast.

- What is Multi-threading Sales and Why Do You Need to Start Doing It?
- The Tactical Guide to Multi-Threading Sales

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Supplemental Resources

Overall Discovery

- Executing Great Discovery podcast (31 minutes)
- Discovery is a Process featuring Matt Petrovick (GitLab Strategic Account Executive) (2.5 minutes)
- Matt Petrovick's Favorite Discovery Call (3 minutes)
- Matt Petrovick's Most Memorable Discovery Call (2 minutes)

Preparation

- Be Match Ready! featuring Peter Davies (GitLab Strategic Account Executive) (2 minutes)

Active Listening

- Improve Your Active Listening Skills podcast (15 minutes)
- Why Are You Talking? podcast (9 minutes)
- Use the Customer's Words and Stop Talking featuring Peter Davies (GitLab Strategic Account Executive) (0.5 minutes)

Attaching to the Biggest Problem

- How to Enable Reps to Sell Higher podcast (27 minutes)

Identifying the Negative Consequences of Doing Nothing

- Standing in the Moment of Pain (1 minute)

Multi-Threading

- Navigating the Decision Process with Multiple Buyers podcast (11.5 minutes)
- Multi-threading with Application Security featuring Matt Petrovick (GitLab Strategic Account Executive) (1 minute)

SECTION: sales/process/_index.md

SECTION: sales/process/account-management.md

Touching base with standard subscribers

Preparing renewal

What is an order?

1. A Purchase Order (PO) issued by the company
1. A signed quote (the quote that we send)
1. An e-mail agreement ("we accept the quote/subscription/etc") or any other written statement

Development work management

Do NOT invoice before feature/work is completed.

- Feature is requested by customer

- Sales creates issue in issue tracker that links to the email (tags: company name, feature, estimate) and, if needed, mentions in agenda. Issue is assigned to sales milestone

- Dev makes estimate/gives feedback

1. Estimate: between x and y hours (if it takes much time to do an estimate and we doubt if the customer will order)

1. Quote: x number of hours (in all other cases)

- Sales communicates estimate to customer

- Repeat 3 and 4 in case of a range estimate

- If customer agrees with estimate and feedback, then:

1. Add estimate and order to the hourly tab of the Sales sheet

1. Sales removes estimate label and adds promised label

1. Sales adds comment on milestone and context of developer agreeing on the milestone, changes milestone in the issue

1. Adds the issue name and link to the feature in the deal

- If customer does not commit in a reasonable time, issue is marked as closed and sales follows up through the deal

- If feature will not be done, sales marks issue as closed

- Once feature is delivered, adds number of hours spent in the deal, sales announces customer, closes feature with link to email

- Sales adds the real number of hours spent to the sales sheet

- Sales invoices customer for the quoted number of hours

- Deal is marked won

- Implicit handover between sales and finance is sending the invoice (Sytse)

Consultancy work management

1. Customer contacts sales for consultancy work

1. Sales sends email to support@ with details and time estimate

1. Support will OTB (OK to book) or ask for more information

1. If more information is needed sales will ask it and add to the Zendesk ticket

1. If OTB and customer agrees with the estimate, sales will ask the customer to contact support@ for booking time and adds to the sales sheet 'Hourly' as quoted

1. After ordering, sales marks deal as won and amends sales sheet

1. If, during the call, the time allocated on the quote is exceeded, the Support Engineer will inform the client that they are going overtime, and that all overtime will be invoiced to the client at normal consultancy rate

1. If an unforeseen GitLab bug needs to be fixed in order to address the consultancy request, the Support Engineer will inform the client that GitLab B.V. will make the fix, and that the additional hours spent will be invoiced to the client at normal consultancy rate

1. If the work is finished or the client decides to stop the consultancy process, support logs the hours spent in the 'Hourly' sales sheet, column "Realized" and informs sales via email or Highrise

1. Support notifies customer via Zendesk that Sales will be in touch with them

1. Sales creates invoice corresponding to the number of hours in the "Realized" column

Handover from sales to support for subscription clients

1. Sales includes a link to the relevant Highrise deal

1. Support looks in the highrise deal, if the conversation is too long they leave a note in Highrise asking for a summary

Support for potential customers

1. Sales hears about a bug / issue the potential customer is having and decides that GitLab should try to solve it in the interest of winning the deal. At that point:

- Sales asks the customer to email support regarding their issue; OR
- Sales forwards the issue from the customer to support, and in doing so also puts the sales team in the cc to avoid creating duplicate tickets for the Support Team.

Creating an Issue for feature requests

1. Create an issue and mention someone (Dimitriy, Sytse, Job).

1. Do not mention customer name but confirm if large, medium, or small, and include URL to Salesforce account.

SECTION: sales/process/version-check/index.md

Blog post about version check

What is the functionality of the GitLab Version Check?

GitLab Version Check is a suite of UI elements focused on communicating to instance admins the status of their current instance's version. The status is communicated through various elements depending on how critical the version they are behind is.

GitLab Version Check UI Suite

GitLab Version Badge

Description

This badge element is always visible and communicates the GitLab instance version in relation to the upgrades available.

- Up to date: GitLab instance is fully up to date with the current version of GitLab.

- Update available: GitLab instance is outdated behind a non-security related version of GitLab.
- Update ASAP: GitLab instance is outdated behind a security related version of GitLab.

UI Representation

```
| Up to date | Update available | Update ASAP |
| ----- | ----- | ----- |
|  |
 |  |
```

UI Location(s)

- Admin Dashboard (Components Section)
- Help Page
- Help Dropdown (? icon in top navigation)

When to appear

- Always

<hr />

GitLab Critical Security Upgrade Modal

Description

This Modal element is only visible when a GitLab instance is behind a security upgrade that could make the instance vulnerable. This modal appears and forces a interaction before going away. Depending on how verbose the upgrade notes are, the modal can appear with various levels of details. Additionally, when it appears, the admin is faced with a choice. Regardless of the choice made, the modal will be hidden and set to reappear in 3 days.

- Upgrade now: Admin is navigated to the upgrade documentation
- Remind me in 3 days: Modal is hidden

UI Representation

```
| No Stable Versions or Details | Stable Versions but no Details | Both Stable Versions and
Details |
| ----- | ----- | ----- |
| | | |
```

UI Location(s)

- Everywhere

When to appear

- If behind a danger level upgrade, always and dismissible for 3 day periods

How does the GitLab Version Check work?

In the past we used to provide the version check to the UI through an API call that you could see in your Network tab. This has changed and is now provided to the UI through Rails.

The current architecture is a bit complicated due to the nature of the ReactiveCaching mechanism we are using. This cache is powered by Sidekiq and is executed through Background Jobs (/admin/backgroundjobs) with the goal of housing and rehydrating your instance's version status. We have an aggressive caching mechanism due to the nature of this data being fetched from an external endpoint and being needed throughout the GitLab application.

We have an exploration started into transitioning to Cron with a more traditional caching approach.

Below is a visual representation of how Version Check is managed behind the scenes:

```
mermaid
graph TD
    Z[Start] --> A
    A[Version Request] --> B{Is Cached?}
    B -->|Yes| C[Get Cache]
    B -->|No| F[Schedule Immediate Sidekiq Job]
    C -->|Data| A
    C --> D[Reset 12hr Job Timer]
    D --> E[Schedule 12hr Sidekiq Job]
    E --> G
    F --> G[Fetch Version from External API]
    G --> H{Success?}
    H -->|No| F
    H -->|Yes| I[Write to Cache]
    I --> D
```

Which information does the browser request contain?

The request contains information about the browser, the GitLab version and the HTTP referrer. The HTTP referrer is the URL from which the request was sent. So it is the URL of the help page or the admin area page of the admin's GitLab instance. E.g. if you visit the help page on gitlab.com the HTTP referrer is <https://gitlab.com/help>. Furthermore the browser has to send the IP address of the instance combined with the request to receive a response. None of this information is saved.

What is version.gitlab.com?

Version.gitlab.com responds to the requests mentioned above with

up-to-date version information. It does not save any of the provided data.

Which information can be derived from the HTTP referrer?

The HTTP referrer can contain the local or public hostname or IP address of a GitLab instance. It depends on how the admin accessed the GitLab web interface. Local hostnames and local IP addresses are only relevant and reachable within the local network in which the instance is running. Therefore local hostnames can be named anything, for example 'myownGitLab'. Public hostnames or IP addresses can contain information about the owner of the host network. For example if the HTTP referrer contains 'dev.gitlab.org' it is assumable that this instance is owned by GitLab.

Troubleshooting

Use the internal API to check the cache

By hitting the `/admin/versioncheck.json` endpoint you can see if there is cached data and what is being provided to the UI through Rails.

If the response is null there are few steps you can take:

- Ensure your network is whitelisting/allowing an external API request to reach out to `version.gitlab.com`.
- Ensure there is a background job scheduled in Sidekiq and it isn't stuck behind something.

Ensure Sidekiq jobs are in healthy state

By visiting `/admin/backgroundjobs`, you can look into what jobs are scheduled/running/pending on your instance.

The job you will be looking for is called `externalserviceactivecaching`.

If the internal API is returning null or the upgrade badge is missing:

- Ensure there is a job scheduled ASAP and determine how to unblock it from executing.
- If the job is scheduled far out, force it to execute because something may have mis-queued in Sidekiq.

How do I disable GitLab Version Check

GitLab Version Check can be disabled via the Metrics and Profiling tab of the GitLab Admin Settings.

You can find the checkbox labeled "Enable version check" at `/admin/applicationsettings/metricsandprofiling` in the Usage Statistics section.

SECTION: sales/qbrs/index.md

Quarterly Business Review (QBR) Overview

QBRs are held during the first two weeks of every quarter. The sessions span between 5-7 business days. The goal of these sessions is to:

1. Review team performance and lessons learned from the past quarter
1. Review customer wins, use cases and insights to repeat "what good looks like"
1. Review current quarter forecast and plans to meet and exceed sales goals in the coming quarter (and beyond)
1. Prepare CRO and GitLab E-Group for GitLab's quarterly earnings report
1. Identify and prioritize specific requests that will help Sales be successful

QBRs are categorized into two types:

1. Quarterly Business Reviews (QBRs) - These sessions are held at the team- / IC-level and are organized by managers.
1. Field Manager QBRs - These sessions include Field Managers and above and are organized by the QBR planning team. Most of the page below covers the process for Field Manager QBRs.

QBR Schedules

Field Manager QBRs are held in the following months and typically are a mix of in-person and virtual formats. This is subject to change based on any outside conditions that make it unsafe for the team to travel (i.e. COVID-19) and GitLab's travel policy.

1. Feb: In-Person (FY24 TBD)
1. May: Virtual
1. Aug: Virtual
1. Nov: In-Person

Field Manager QBRs are typically organized by region and are held starting at the ASM/manager level and roll up by leadership tier from there. ASMs/managers are responsible for gathering the necessary insights and asks from their teams in self-organized, team-level QBRs. See QBR Best Practices section for more information. Schedule overlap is avoided to the best of the planning team's ability, but note that some overlap, especially cross-segment, is typically unavoidable.

See below for a list of QBR sessions by segment.

ENT Sales QBRs

1. ENT AMER Geo
 1. East Central
 1. Northeast
 1. Southeast
 1. West
 1. PacNW & Midwest, Rockies/SoCal
1. ENT PubSec Geo
 1. National Security Group (NSG includes DHS, DoJ, and DoE)
 1. Civilian

- 1. DoD
- 1. SLED
- 1. FSI
- 1. ENT EMEA Geo
 - 1. EMEA North
 - 1. EMEA South
 - 1. DACH
- 1. ENT APAC
- 1. ENT AMER Regional
 - 1. AMER East
 - 1. AMER West
- 1. ENT Leadership
 - 1. ENT AMER
 - 1. ENT PubSec
 - 1. ENT EMEA
 - 1. ENT APAC

COMM Sales QBRs

- 1. COMM SMB - AMER & EMEA
- 1. COMM MM - AMER & EMEA
- 1. COMM SMB & MM - APAC
- 1. COMM Sales Leadership (Closed Session)

Channel & Alliances QBRs

- 1. Channels & Alliances Program Leadership
 - 1. Alliances
 - 1. Programs & Services
 - 1. Channel Ops
 - 1. Partner SA
 - 1. Channel GTM
 - 1. Channel Marketing
- 1. Channel Geo/Field Leadership
 - 1. EMEA Channel
 - 1. PubSec Channel
 - 1. AMER Channel

CS QBRs

- 1. CSM Team - AMER & EMEA
- 1. CSM Team - APAC
- 1. SA Team
- 1. PubSec CS Team
- 1. Professional Services Team
- 1. CS Leadership

Field Manager QBR Participation - Virtual

Field Manager QBRs include managers, leadership, and delegates from across the business: (for leadership QBR or CS QBR participation details, see below)

1. All Sales, Channel, and Customer Success ASMs or managers applicable for the QBR session

1. All Sales, Channel, and Customer Success leaders applicable for the QBR session (i.e. VP, AVP, RD)

1. 1-2 delegates from the following teams will participate

1. Sales Dev

1. Field Marketing

1. Product Marketing

1. Demand Gen

1. Product

1. Sales Ops

1. Field Enablement

1. Channel/Alliance

1. People Team

1. Optional GTM leaders (indicates optional on the QBR invite)

1. CRO

1. All CRO Leadership

1. CMO

1. VP Revenue Marketing

1. VP Demand Gen

1. VP Product Management

1. Sr. Director of Sales Operations

1. Sr. Director Field Enablement

1. Sr. Director of Professional Services

1. Sr. Manager of Sales Operations

1. Field Enablement Program Manager (applicable for the QBR session, i.e. Sr. Program Manager, Commercial Sales Enablement)

1. Field EBAs

1. Field Talent Acquisition Team

1. Customer Reference

1. Field Security

ENT Leadership QBR

1. Segment Sales VP

1. Segment Sales VP direct reports (RDs, ASMs, and Inside Sales Managers)

1. Chief Revenue Officer (CRO) and CRO Chief of Staff (both optional)

1. Chief Marketing Officer (CMO) (optional)

1. CRO direct reports

1. VP of Demand Gen

1. VP of Revenue Marketing

1. VP of Product Management

1. VP of Field Ops direct reports

1. Sr. Program Manager, ENT Sales Enablement

1. Sr. Program Manager, Customer Success Enablement (optional)

COMM Leadership QBR

- 1. Segment Sales VP
- 1. Segment Sales VP direct reports (RDs, ASMs)
- 1. People Business Partner
- 1. Field Operations, COMM Support
- 1. Program Managers, COMM Sales Enablement

CS Leadership QBR

- 1. VP Customer Success
- 1. VP Customer Success direct reports
- 1. Chief Revenue Officer (CRO) and CRO EBA (both optional)
- 1. Chief Marketing Officer (CMO) (optional)
- 1. CRO direct reports
- 1. VP of Demand Gen
- 1. VP of Revenue Marketing
- 1. VP of Product Management
- 1. VP of Field Ops direct reports
- 1. People Business Partners
- 1. VP, Product Marketing
- 1. Sr. Program Manager, Customer Success Enablement

Field Manager QBR Participation - In-Person

Participation in in-person Field Manager QBRs differs from virtual settings in order to maintain efficient budget and travel schedules. Only managers+ will be permitted to attend Field QBRs in-person · this includes attendees both in the Field organization and in supporting organizations:

- 1. CRO LT
- 1. Regional Sales Leaders (ASM) / Managers+ of Customer Success or Channel & Alliances
- 1. Inside Sales Leaders
- 1. Regional SA & CSM Managers
- 1. Channels & Alliances Leaders
- 1. Professional Services Leaders
- 1. Global and/or Regional Field Operations Leaders
- 1. Sales Dev Leader or Regional SDR Managers
- 1. Field Marketing & Demand Gen Leaders
- 1. People Team
- 1. Product Marketing Leaders
- 1. Product Delegate

Any attendees that fall outside of the roles listed above will need to go through an approval process in order to attend in-person Field Manager QBRs. More details on the approval process coming soon.

Example: While each region has a dedicated Field Marketer who may regularly attend virtual Field Manager QBRs, only the Director of Field Marketing (or a designated delegate) will be permitted to attend in-person QBRs for budgetary considerations.

Wherever possible, the QBR planning team will incorporate the ability for team members to

participate in in-person QBRs virtually so that team members who 1) are not comfortable traveling or 2) are not permitted to attend in-person can still participate in and contribute to Field Manager QBRs.

QBR Best Practices

Best Practices for Managers/ASMs/RDs/AVPs

1. Managers/ASMs are responsible for gathering insights and input from their teams to inform their Field Manager QBR presentations. These sessions should be self-organized by the managers. It is recommended that managers look at these QBR sessions as "family discussions" and keep them simple and informal to encourage team openness and knowledge-sharing.

1. Depending on the Field Manager QBR, RDs, AVPs or VPs are considered the "hosts" of their QBR sessions. As the hosts, these leaders serve as the DRI for the attendance and schedule of their sessions. Therefore, please ensure you are being thoughtful when providing the QBR planning team with your attendee list and schedule for your session.

1. Field Manager QBRs should be an inclusive environment · QBR hosts should encourage participation from other members of their extended teams as well as delegates from other areas of the business.

1. Invite your Channel Manager, SDR Manager, Field Marketing delegate, and/or CSM Manager to provide a brief (5 minute) update during each QBR.

1. NOTE: ENT ASMs will co-present with SA managers.

1. Any changes to the Field Manager QBR schedules should be made no later than two weeks before the scheduled start of virtual QBRs and 2 months before the scheduled start of in-person QBRs to avoid calendar disruptions for participants.

1. All managers/ASMs should complete their Field Manager QBR decks no later than 2 business days prior to their Field Manager QBR session. (Note: For QBRs that occur on the first business day of the new quarter, the standard is one business day.)

1. All AVPs/RDs/ASMs should pre-read other QBR decks for their session. Questions should be left ahead of time in the coordinating notes document.

1. RDs/AVPs should review their team's QBR asks and pre-prepare a list of prioritized asks to review in their Field Manager QBR session. (See the Field Operations QBR Request Intake Process below for more information.)

Best Practices for Attendees

1. Please join on time and ensure your microphone is muted to avoid disruptions.

1. Please be an active participant in the QBR session · join on video (if possible), answer questions related to your area of expertise/team, and participate in discussions.

1. Please contribute by taking notes during the QBRs. Everyone can (and should!) contribute, but delegates from these teams are expected to pitch in on note taking:

1. Sales Operations

1. Field Enablement

1. Product Marketing

1. Field Marketing

1. Sales Dev

1. Channel

1. Alliances

1. Notes taken during QBRs should provide a detailed summary of the QBR and focus on key takeaways, value-add commentary and conversation. Since QBRs are not recorded, notes are the

record of the QBR. See Note Taking section below for full note taking guidance.

QBR Communication

1. QBR-related Slack channels will be created no later than five weeks before the start of Field Manager QBRs.

1. The naming will follow this format:

- 1. qbr-comm-qxfyxx
- 1. qbr-ent-qxfyxx
- 1. qbr-channel-alliances-qxfyxx
- 1. qbr-cs-qxfyxx

1. These channels will be used to:

- 1. Coordinate asks/reminders for RD/ASM planning action items.
- 1. Send reminders about QBR schedules and timing.
- 1. Field questions about attendance.

1. Field logistical questions (i.e. "what's the Zoom link?") that arise as QBRs are in process.

1. Conduct follow-ups to QBR asks. (i.e. share how/where we have tracked QBR asks and inform the field of the process that will happen next to address them and where to look for updates)

1. Uses do not include:

1. Facilitate manager approval or feedback for QBR decks. This is meant to be handled by managers with their leaders via their own preferred channels.

1. Make any QBR asks that should be included in QBR decks.

1. These channels will be archived within 60 days of QBRs being completed.

QBR Note Taking

The purpose of notes is to summarize and capture meaningful insights that come out of the conversation during a QBR - questions and answers, feedback, asks, etc.

Q: Who should take notes?

A: If you are attending as a delegate, please note that it is part of your responsibility to contribute to note-taking in the QBR.

Q: What specific information should the delegate capture?

A: In order to serve as an active participant in QBRs, there is no need to take verbatim notes during the sessions. Providing a detailed summary of information that is shared is adequate.

1. Make as detailed notes as possible pertaining to key insights, decisions, asks, action items, or specific improvement requests. Please include reference to the specific slide in the QBR presentation that pertains to the ask when possible. While the slides will not be shared with the broader team, this information will help key stakeholders easily find the referenced information.

1. Capture meaningful insights, points or key decisions that come from conversations during the QBR, not information already written in a slide.

Where to Find Past Field Manager QBRs

1. In accordance with our SAFE framework, Field Manager QBR sessions are not recorded. Please refer to session notes instead. If you do not have access to the session notes, please request this directly from the QBR host.

Field Operations QBR Ask/Request Process

Field Manager QBR Asks - Best Practices

1. Be very specific in your ask; general asks are not actionable. Asks should be geared towards helping customers & prospects; improving internal processes & productivity.

1. General topics of asks are: Product enhancement, Process, Pricing, Tooling, Etc.

1. Business Impact: Explain how the "Ask" will impact the business. Will improve the customer engagement? Will it make the sales team more productive? Will it foster better collaboration amongst internal teams?

1. Owner (DRI): Assign the Directly Responsible Individual (DRI) for this ask. The DRI cannot be a Sales Mgr/Leader or Rep.

1. Requested Due Date: Provide a due date for the request. This will assist with prioritization for the DRIs and internal teams working on the ask.

1. Bonus: If there is an issue that has been created for your ask, link it in your deck!

1. The Ask should focus on cross-functional teams. Try to avoid "intra-sales" asks that can be addressed during the quarter as a standard course of business.

Intake

1. ASMs are encouraged to share their top asks for leadership and supporting teams as a part of their QBRs. The asks will be prioritized by segment leadership before being passed off to Sales Ops.

1. Enterprise Ask Prioritization Process

1. ASM collects asks from teams, prioritizes and includes a slide of the top 3 asks in their QBR presentation

1. RDs/AVPs will review and prioritize their region's top asks and present them in the ENT Leadership QBR.

1. RDs and ENT Sales VP will review full list of ENT asks in subsequent RD meeting and will deliver a final list of prioritized ENT asks (no more than 5 asks per functional group) no later than the Monday following the ENT Leadership QBR.

1. Commercial Ask Prioritization Process

1. ASM collects asks from teams, prioritizes and includes a slide of the top 3 asks in their QBR presentation

1. RDs will present their region's top asks in the COMM Leadership QBR.

1. ASMs, RDs and COMM Sales VP will review full list of COMM asks and will deliver a final list of prioritized COMM asks no later than the Monday following the COMM Leadership QBR.

1. Field Operations will share a list of consolidated QBR asks and next steps for each no later than three weeks following the last QBR.

1. The DRI for each ask is responsible for creating a new issue related to the QBRR ask OR identifying and updating an existing issue.

1. Leaders/Managers are encouraged to discuss any asks that were not included in the final list with the requestor in their 1:1 to determine how/if any action should be taken.

1. NOTE: Reps can/should make asks of Field Ops at any time outside of QBRs using this template.

Execution and Tracking

All new QBR asks are tracked and managed as issues within the DRI's team Project and will include a global QBR label and year/quarter specific FYxx-Qx QBR label to ensure the asks are categorized appropriately for review.

Sample Field Manager QBR Roll-Out - Virtual

Below is a sample roll-out of the Field Manager QBR planning and execution process that is followed for virtual QBRs. This process is subject to change based on field leadership feedback and priorities. If you have questions, please reach out in field-enablement-team.

1 month before end of Q4 (each FY)

1. Field Events, Field EBAs and Field Comms to collaborate and present a tentative schedule of Field Manager QBRs for the following 4 quarters, including a recommendation on which quarters will include virtual vs. in-person QBRs.

- 1. Field Comms to socialize to segment VPs for buy-in
- 1. Once approved, socialize to all AVPs and RDs for buy-in

5 weeks before Field Manager QBRs are scheduled to start

1. Field Events & Field EBAs to finalize initial QBR Schedule, Attendee and Agenda document. (See past documents in the Field Operations Google Drive folder.)

1. Field Comms will provide a sample agenda for ENT and COMM segments to be used as a reference point for QBR hosts.

1. Field Events and Field EBAs establish a timeline of key dates and milestones

1. Field Comms to create a QBR issue that will be used to share:

- 1. Agenda documents
- 1. Deck templates
- 1. Notes documents for each session
- 1. A checklist of key dates and milestones

1. Field Comms and Field Events will host a "Field Manager QBR Kickoff Call" with the CRO, Segment VPs, and all Field Managers and above to overview the upcoming QBR planning process and reiterate asks/responsibilities. (All field managers will be added as optional.)

1. If there are no material changes in the schedule or QBR process, this call can be canceled in favor of an async approach.

1. Field Comms to stand up QBR-specific Slack channels to address questions and requests from field managers.

1. Designated QBR hosts for each session (AVPs/RDs/ASMs or equivalent) to provide input in the following areas by EOW.

1. Final approval/check on the assigned date for their QBR

1. A full list of attendees · team members, relevant SA/CSM managers, any delegates they want to ensure are included (SDR managers, PMMs, etc.)

1. Please note that RDs/ASMs are not required to select delegates from other teams for their sessions. This is a chance to request a specific team member (ex. a specific SDR manager). If an RD/ASM chooses not to, Field Enablement will work with managers from these teams to select delegates for each session.

1. Logistical details (i.e. personal Zoom room link)

4 weeks before QBRs are scheduled to start

1. Field EBAs to send out initial QBR calendar hold invites that include the following attendees:

- 1. RDs, ASMs, and any other team members for that region - mandatory
- 1. GTM leaders - optional (See QBR Participation section above for full list)

1. Field Events to engage delegate organizations to assign attendees from the following teams for each QBR in the QBR Schedule, Attendee and Agenda document by EOW.

- 1. Sales Dev
- 1. Field Marketing
- 1. Product Marketing
- 1. Demand Gen
- 1. Product
- 1. Sales Ops
- 1. Field Enablement
- 1. Channel/Alliance
- 1. People Team
- 1. Inside Sales

1. Field Operations in coordination with Enablement Program Managers begin working with VPs on QBR deck templates (if applicable).

3 weeks before QBRs are scheduled to start

1. Field Operations in coordination with Enablement Program Managers finalize QBR deck templates with VPs. QBR deck templates distributed to leaders for them to cascade down to their teams.

1. Sales Ops to create notes spreadsheet and notes documents for each QBR. Notes document to include the following:

- 1. Note Taking Best Practices
- 1. Example notes section
- 1. Link to final QBR schedule

1. AVPs/RDs/ASMs to populate final QBR schedules in their respective QBR Schedule, Attendee and Agenda document/tab by EOW following the best-practices outlined in their respective Sample Schedule.

2 weeks before QBRs are scheduled to start

1. Further scheduling changes for QBR sessions are discouraged in order to avoid disruptions for attendees.

1. Field EBAs update existing QBR calendar invites with updated details:

- 1. Delegate assignments for each session
- 1. Link to notes document
- 1. Final schedule in spreadsheet tab

1 week before QBRs are scheduled to start

1. ASMs/managers encouraged to complete their self-organized, team-level QBR sessions to gather final details for their Field Manager QBR presentations.

1. Field Comms to create a "Manager Responsibilities" issue outlining the asks/responsibilities for QBR hosts before, during and after the calls and socialize this issue in the QBR Slack

channels.

1. Field Comms to send a reminder to all QBR delegates regarding the attendee best-practices outlined above in QBR Slack channels.

Week(s) of QBRs

1. The AVP/RD or equivalent will lead the meeting.
1. Assigned note takers will take QBR notes following the best practices outlined above.
1. Field EBAs and Field Events should consistently monitor the QBR Slack channels for questions.

1 week following QBRs

1. Field Comms to create a QBR feedback issue and socialize the link in each QBR Slack channel. Issue will remain open for two weeks after the final QBR session.
1. Field Ops team begins triaging and actioning on QBR asks. Execute on top-priority asks in a Cannonball run.

3 weeks following QBRs

1. Field Ops completes initial review and assignment of consolidated/prioritized QBR asks in an issue. Assigns asks to the appropriate DRIs. Determines which Ops-related asks will be actioned on in the quarterly Cannonball run.
1. Field Ops collaborates with Field Comms to socialize the consolidated list of QBR asks and next steps.

Sample Field Manager QBR Roll-Out - In-Person

Below is a sample roll-out of the Field Manager QBR planning and execution process that is followed for in-person QBRs. This process is subject to change based on field leadership feedback and priorities. If you have questions, please reach out in field-enablement-team.

1 month before end of Q4 (each FY)

1. Field Events, Field EBAs and Field Comms to collaborate and present a tentative schedule of Field Manager QBRs for the following 4 quarters, including a recommendation on which quarters will include virtual vs. in-person QBRs.
 1. Field Comms to socialize to segment VPs for buy-in
 1. Once approved, socialize to all AVPs and RDs for buy-in

3 months before QBRs are scheduled to start

1. Field Events to create a workback plan of all key dates and milestones.
1. Field Comms to create a QBR issue that will be used to share:
 1. Agenda documents
 1. Deck templates
 1. Notes documents for each session
 1. A checklist of key dates and milestones
1. Field Events to send a calendar hold to all Field leadership sharing in-person QBR dates and location.

1. Field Events & Field EBAs to create an initial QBR Schedule, Attendee and Agenda document.
1. Field Events & Field EBAs to circulate above document to Field leaders / QBR hosts to ask for input on in-person attendees at their session. All input should be provided by leaders/QBR hosts within two weeks.
1. CRO Chief of Staff and CRO LT to review list of requested attendees. Once reviewed and approved, the attendee list will be considered final and any additional attendees will be required to go through a formal approval process.

2 months before QBRs are scheduled to start

1. Field Events to set up a landing page for in-person QBRs that will serve as a SSOT for event details. Collaborate with Field Comms on an FAQ to be included on this page.
1. Field Comms and Field Events to co-host a "In-Person Field Manager QBR Kickoff Session" sharing event dates, initial event details and upcoming asks.
1. Field Events to work with field leadership and leadership of delegate organizations to determine who should participate in the QBR sessions virtually (if applicable).
1. Field Comms to stand up QBR-specific Slack channels to address questions and requests from field managers. All approved QBR attendees will be added. Channel should be monitored by Field Events and EBAs in addition to Comms for full coverage.
1. In-Person QBR registration opens.

4 weeks before QBRs are scheduled to start

1. Field EBAs to send out final QBR calendar invites to all approved in-person attendees. Separate calendar invites should go out to all virtual attendees with Zoom details.
1. AVPs/RDs/ASMs to populate final QBR schedules in their respective QBR Schedule, Attendee and Agenda document/tab by EOW following the best-practices outlined in their respective Sample Schedule.
1. Field Operations in coordination with Enablement Program Managers begin working with VPs on QBR deck templates (if applicable).

3 weeks before QBRs are scheduled to start

1. Field Operations in coordination with Enablement Program Managers finalize QBR deck templates with VPs. QBR deck templates distributed to leaders for them to cascade down to their teams.
1. Sales Ops to create notes spreadsheet and notes documents for each QBR. Notes document to include the following:
 1. Note Taking Best Practices
 1. Example notes section
 1. Link to final QBR schedule

1 week before QBRs are scheduled to start

1. ASMs/managers encouraged to complete their self-organized, team-level QBR sessions to gather final details for their Field Manager QBR presentations.
1. Field Comms to create a "Manager Responsibilities" issue outlining the asks/responsibilities for QBR hosts before, during and after the calls and socialize this issue in the QBR Slack channels.
1. Field Comms to send a reminder to all QBR delegates regarding the attendee best-practices

outlined above in QBR Slack channels.

Week(s) of QBRs

1. The AVP/RD or equivalent will lead the meeting.
1. Assigned note takers will take QBR notes following the best practices outlined above.
1. Field Events & Field EBAs should consistently monitor the QBR Slack channels for questions.

1 week following QBRs

1. Field Comms to create a QBR feedback issue and socialize the link in each QBR Slack channel. Issue will remain open for two weeks after the final QBR session.
1. Field Ops team begins triaging and actioning on QBR asks. Execute on top-priority asks in a Cannonball run.

3 weeks following QBRs

1. Field Ops completes initial review and assignment of consolidated/prioritized QBR asks in an issue. Assigns asks to the appropriate DRIs. Determines which Ops-related asks will be actioned on in the quarterly Cannonball run.
1. Field Ops collaborates with Field Comms to socialize the consolidated list of QBR asks and next steps.

SECTION: sales/readmes/_index.md

SECTION: sales/readmes/francis-potter.md

Mission

I serve clients throughout North America with CICD translation, modernization, and transformation.

Success goes beyond replacing legacy CICD platforms. Effective end-to-end automation has a powerful impact.

- Drives higher levels of performance
- Contributes to employee satisfaction
- Fosters generative culture
- Unlocks innovation
- Separates the extraordinary from the mediocre

Background

Previously I served as a Senior Solution Architect (presales) and Product Marketing Manager

(competitive intelligence). I first joined the GitLab team at the beginning of 2019.

Before GitLab, I ran a tiny independent professional services firm after serving for years as a senior engineering manager and product manager for various tech startups. My career has touched the worlds of content delivery (CDN), marketing software, sports media, meteorology, translation, social media, print production, international social justice, and SETI. Go to LinkedIn for a complete professional background.

Outside of this amazing organization, I consider myself an open source Python developer, brain tumour survivor, aspie, Rotarian, gender non-conformist, LGBTQ2S+ ally, concertgoer, musical theatre nut, electric guitar dabbler, MotoGP follower, Rush fan, husband, father, Canadian, and resident of the traditional territory of the K'ómoks people.

Finally, those values? We really follow them, every moment of every day.

SECTION: sales/readmes/ian-steward.md

Ian Steward's README

Why I'm at GitLab

I'd long been aware of developers' and enterprises' love for GitLab's products, as well as the company's unwavering commitment to their values and unique culture. After spending time with the management team and Board, I realized that there was a confluence of factors that created an opportunity for GitLab to become an enduring generational company.

T